THE ROBOT FIGHTING CLASSIC · REMASTERED EDITION



GAME MANUAL

FOR WINDOWS AND THE WEB

One Must Fall 2097 © 1994 Diversions Entertainment · Freeware since 1999 · Unofficial fan remaster

WARNING: READ BEFORE PLAYING

A very small number of people have seizures when they see flashing lights or patterns, including those in video games, even without any history of epilepsy. This game has flashes of light (hits, knockouts, camera flashes, lightning). If you or anyone in your family has had a seizure, ask a doctor before playing. Stop playing at once and see a doctor if you feel dizzy, see things oddly, twitch, or lose awareness.

Play in a well-lit room, sit well back from the screen, and take a 10 to 15 minute break every hour. The remastered effects (flashes included) can be turned off in **Options › Graphics › Effects**.

ABOUT THIS MANUAL

Welcome, pilot. This booklet covers everything in **One Must Fall 2097 Remastered**: the original 1994 game, rebuilt to play its original data on today's computers, and everything the remaster adds on top. Read it cover to cover, or keep it next to the keyboard and look things up between rounds. That is what the pros do.

Throughout this manual, keys look like `ENTER` and moves are written the way the game writes them: joystick directions for a robot facing right, then the button. ↓ ↘ → P means *down, down-forward, forward, punch*, one smooth motion. Facing left, forward and back swap sides.

THE F1 KEY

Stuck? Press `F1` at any time for the game's own help pages. In a fight, the pause menu's **Move list** shows every command of both robots.

QUICK START

1. Run the game. 2. At the main menu, press `ENTER` on **One player game**. 3. Pick a pilot and a robot with the arrow keys and `ENTER`. 4. Walk with `←` `→`, punch with `ENTER`, kick with `R-SHIFT`, block by holding back. 5. Win.

THE DISK IN YOUR HAND

There is no disk, of course. The whole game is a free download, and so is this manual. One Must Fall 2097 has been freeware since 1999: its owners let everyone share it, as long as nobody charges for it. **If you paid for this game, you were robbed.**

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THE FIRE PIT *Milano's Pyros and Ibrahim's Chronos settle it over the lava grate.*

CHAPTER 1

WELCOME TO THE YEAR 2097

The twenty-first century built the robots. The twenty-second will be won by whoever pilots them best.

By 2097 the great corporations have outgrown their nations, and the greatest of them is **W.A.R.**, World Aeronautics and Robotics. W.A.R. builds the machines that are colonizing space: **HARs**, Human Assisted Robots, ninety feet of armor and hydraulics controlled by a pilot through a neural link. A HAR moves when its pilot thinks.

Machines that strong must be tested, and W.A.R. found a way to test them in front of the whole world. In arenas built for the purpose, pilots from every corner of the globe fight each other's robots to a standstill, round after round, while the cameras roll and the money changes hands.

For the pilots, the arena is a way out. Some fight for the prize money, some for revenge, some for the glory of a title. A few fight because W.A.R. owns their debts. All of them know the rule of the arena, and the name of the game: of the two robots in the ring, **one must fall**.

Behind it all stands **Major Kreissack**, the man who runs the tournament circuit for W.A.R., with his bodyguard Raven at his side. The winners of the circuit are promised a match with the Major himself, in a machine no one else is allowed to pilot.

Your career begins in the Stadium, where W.A.R.'s new machines get their first public testing. Where it ends is up to you.



OPENING NIGHT *The crowd waits for the champion.*

WHAT'S NEW IN THE REMASTERED EDITION

This is the complete 1994 game, playing its original data files, with its fight engine, computer opponents, music and sound reproduced faithfully. On top of it, the remaster adds:

- **Two looks, one key.** Flip between the pixel-exact 1994 graphics and an HD remaster at any moment with F2, even in the middle of a fight.
- **3,200+ images redrawn in HD**, widescreen arenas, live lighting, particles, bloom and smooth motion.
- **Four new robots and four new arenas**, built in the spirit of the originals (off until you turn them on).
- **A training lab** with frame data, hitboxes, dummy recording and combo trials.
- **Replays** of every fight, saved as video or animated GIF clips.
- **Arcade, survival and time attack** modes, records and 20 achievements.
- **A robot workshop** to build your own HARs, and **custom tournaments**.
- Gamepads with rumble, a modern keyboard layout, touch controls, one-button specials, your own music, two announcers (a male and a female voice).

A WORD FROM THE REMASTER TEAM

We played this game to pieces in 1994. We wanted it to look the way we remembered it, not the way it really looked on a 14-inch monitor, without changing a single frame of how it plays. Everything new can be switched off. The original is always one key away.



REMASTERED *The Fire Pit in HD. Press F2 and the same moment appears in its original 320 × 200 pixels.*

CHAPTER 2

GETTING STARTED

WINDOWS, MACOS, LINUX

Download the game for your computer from the project's GitHub page (*github.com/Jared-woodruff/OMF-2097-Remastered*, Releases). Nothing to install: the whole game is one file (on a Mac, an app in a zip).

- **Windows** may warn about an unknown publisher: **More info › Run anyway**.
- **macOS**, the first time: **System Settings › Privacy & Security › Open Anyway**.
- **Linux**: let the AppImage run as a program (*chmod +x*).

THE WEB

The game also runs in any modern browser, and keeps working offline after the first visit.

SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

- Windows 10/11, macOS 12+, Linux, or a modern web browser
- A graphics card that speaks WebGL 2 (anything from the last ten years)
- About 250 MB of disk space
- Keyboard, gamepad or touch screen
- A friend to beat (optional)

EVERYTHING INCLUDED

The game's original files come with the download. No CD, no install disks, no serial number, no "insert disk 2".

YOUR SAVED DATA

Settings, tournament careers, replays and records are saved automatically. Screenshots (`PRINT SCREEN`, or `F12` in the desktop app), replays and clips you export go to **Downloads › OMF 2097 Remastered** (in a browser, to its downloads).



THE MAIN MENU *The Jaguar on its stage, the spotlight sweeping over the crowd. Move the mouse and the whole scene leans with you.*

CHAPTER 3

THE MAIN MENU

Use the arrow keys (or the mouse, or a gamepad) to choose, ENTER to select and ESC to go back. The first time the game starts, a setup screen asks how you want it to look and sound; it is all in **Options** later.

ENTRY	WHAT IT DOES
One player game	You against the computer's pilots, one after another.
Multiplayer	Two pilots: one keyboard (or pads), or two computers on your network (LAN). The loser buys the pizza.
Tournament play	The career: create a pilot, win prize money, upgrade your robot, climb the circuit (page 23).
More modes	Arcade, survival and time attack (page 25), the training lab (page 26) and your own tournaments.
Extras	The robot workshop, mods (the new robots and arenas are turned on here), OMF Studio, replays, records and achievements, the scoreboard, the demo and the credits.
Options	Every setting: gameplay (speed, rounds, the computer's skill, advanced rules), controls, graphics, sound and language.
Help	The game's help pages (also F1, anywhere).
Quit	For the faint of heart.



CHOOSE YOUR ROBOT *Pick a pilot, then a HAR. Each pilot's power, agility and endurance change how a robot hits, moves and holds up.*

CHAPTER 4

CONTROLS

The game knows two keyboard layouts (**Options › Controls › Keys and buttons**): the original **classic** layout, and a **modern** one for today's keyboards. Every key can be changed.

	CLASSIC P1	CLASSIC P2	MODERN P1
Move	← → ↑ ↓	A D W X	A D W S
Diagonals	HOME PG UP END PG DN	Q E Z C	two keys at once
Punch	ENTER	L-CTRL F	J
Kick	R-SHIFT	L-SHIFT G	K
Special	/	H	L

The numeric keypad works too for player 1 (8 jump, 2 duck, 0 punch, . kick). In the modern layout, player 2 uses the arrow keys with , punch, . kick and / special.

GAMEPADS

Plug in an Xbox-style controller and press a button: it takes over the next free player. Two button layouts:

	MODERN	CLASSIC
Punch	X Y RB	A X
Kick	A B RT	B Y
Move	D-pad or left stick (eight directions)	
Pause	START	

ONE-BUTTON SPECIALS

New to fighting games? Use the special button (**Options › Controls › Special button**, on from the start): the special key (or pad button) fires a special move of your robot, a different one for each direction you hold. The motions still work too.

HOTKEYS

KEY	ANYWHERE IN THE GAME
F1	Help pages
F2	Switch between the classic and the remastered look
F3	Next song, when your own music is playing
F11 ALT + ENTER	Full screen on and off
PRINT SCREEN F12	Screenshot (F12 in the desktop app)
ESC	Pause in a fight; back in menus

KEY	IN THE TRAINING LAB
F4	Reset the robots' positions (and the current trial)
F5	Take control of the dummy and record what it should do
F6	Play the recording back (or show a trial's demo)
F8	Frame data on and off
F9	Hitboxes on and off

THE MOUSE

Every menu works with the mouse: point and click, right-click to go back. On a touch screen, an on-screen joystick and buttons appear for fights.



CONTROLS *Options › Controls › Keys and buttons shows every key of both players on a keyboard, and every button on the controller page.*

CHAPTER 5

FIGHTING BASICS

THE SCREEN

Each pilot's **health** bar sits at the top, with the **endurance** bar beneath it. Hits take health; every hit you take also drains endurance. The round tokens next to the bars show the rounds won. The first to win the rounds the match needs takes the fight.

MOVING

Walk with forward and back, jump with up (straight, forward or back), duck with down. Every direction is relative to where your robot faces: **forward** is always toward the opponent.

ATTACKING

Two buttons, **punch** and **kick**, give a different attack for each direction you hold: standing, walking, ducking and jumping. Try them all in the training lab: a robot's low kick, its jumping punch and its standing kick are three different tools.

BLOCKING

Hold **back** to block high and **down-back** to block low. A blocked hit does no damage, but it still pushes you back. Some attacks must be blocked low.

THROWS

Close to the opponent, press **forward and punch** (→ P) to grab and throw. Throws cannot be blocked, so they are the answer to a pilot who never stops blocking.

STUN

When the endurance bar runs out, your robot is **stunned**: it staggers, open to anything. Keep an eye on your endurance, and back off to let it recover.



THE SCREEN *Health on top, endurance below it, a round token beside them for every round won, each pilot's name and robot underneath. Steffan's Gargoyle is in trouble.*

SPECIAL MOVES

Every robot has special moves: projectiles, charges, flying attacks. They are entered as a quick motion followed by a button, like ↓↘→ P (a quarter circle forward and punch). The original game never listed them: pilots found them by watching the computer. This manual lists every robot's commands, and so does the pause menu's **Move list**.

COMBOS

Hits that land before the opponent recovers chain into a **combo**: the game counts the hits on screen. Every robot has combos that cannot be escaped once the first hit lands. The training lab's **combo trials** teach them.

FINISHING MOVES

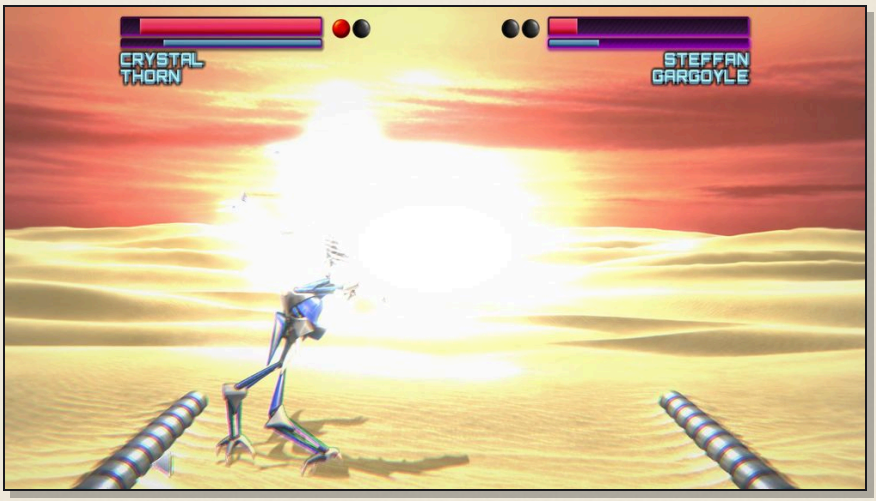
Win the deciding round and your opponent's robot stands helpless for a moment. Enter the robot's **scrap** move to rip it apart, or its **destruction** move for something even more final. The command lists in this manual show both. The announcer will notice.

PILOTS AND ROBOTS

The same robot fights differently in different hands. A pilot's **power** makes hits stronger, **agility** makes the robot faster, and **endurance** makes it harder to stun.

PRO TIP

Watch the demo (Extras › Demo) with the move list in mind. The computer pilots use every special move of their robots, and they are not shy about it.



KNOCKOUT *The final blow: a flash, a shockwave and the camera closing in.*

CHAPTER 6

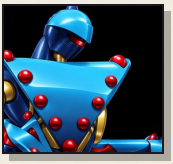
THE ROBOTS

Eleven HARs, each built for a different kind of fight. Choose the one that fits the way you think.

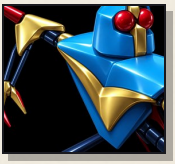
On the following pages, every robot's special moves are named as the game names them, and its **command list** shows how to enter them, as the pause menu's move list does: directions for a robot facing right, then the button (P punch, K kick). A dot means back to neutral before the next direction.



JAGUAR



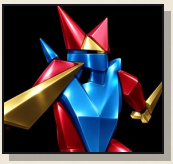
SHADOW



THORN



PYROS



ELECTRA



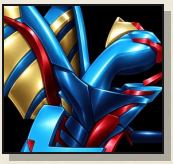
KATANA



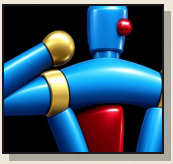
SHREDDER



FLAIL



GARGOYLE



CHRONOS

COLORS

In a fight, every robot wears its pilot's colors: the armor, the joints and the accents each take one of the pilot's three colors. The pictures in this manual show the robots in their factory paint.

The robots are the same in both looks: the remaster redraws them, it does not change them. Every frame, every hit point and every move is the original's.



THE POWER PLANT *Christian's Shadow and Angel's Electra, the electrified fences lighting up the hall.*



JAGUAR

ALL-ROUNDER

The robot most pilots learn on, and the one many never leave. Tall and athletic, with boxy limbs, a pointed crest, swept fins, gold joints and the jaguar mask on its chest, the Jaguar is quick on its feet and quicker to punish: it leaps across the arena, fires a concussion cannon and throws opponents clean over its head.

SPECIAL MOVES

Jaguar Leap · Concussion Cannon · Overhead Throw

COMMAND LIST

THROW → P

SPECIAL ↘ → P

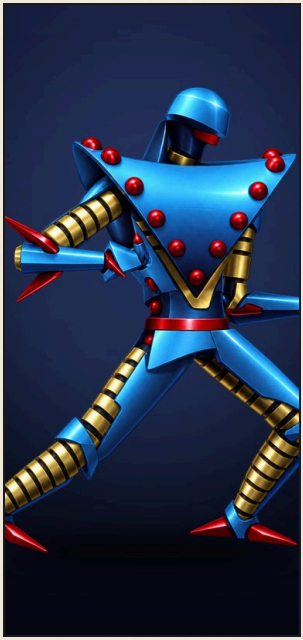
IN THE AIR ↘ → P

DESTRUCTION ↓ • ↑ K

SPECIAL ↙ ↓ ↘ → P

SPECIAL ↙ ← P

SCRAP FINISHER ↓ ↓ • ↑ P



SHADOW

TRICKSTER

A lean ninja of a machine with a smooth hooded head and a wide, riveted torso. The Shadow projects translucent copies of itself, and its shadows strike, slide and grab from where the robot is not. Opponents who watch the robot instead of its shadow do not watch for long.

SPECIAL MOVES

Shadow Dive · Shadow Punch · Shadow Slide · Shadow Grab

COMMAND LIST

THROW → P

SPECIAL ↙ ← K

SPECIAL ↙ ← P

IN THE AIR ↙ ← P

DESTRUCTION ↓ ↓ ↓ P

SPECIAL ↓ ↓ P

SPECIAL ↘ ↓ ↙ ← P

IN THE AIR ↓ ↘ → P

SCRAP FINISHER ← • → ↗ ↑ ↖ ← P



THORN

SPEED

Hunched and spindly, with long red spikes growing from its elbows and knees and a gold cape of armor. Thorn lives on speed and surprise: kicks that come out of nowhere, attacks off the arena walls and a charge that leads with the spikes.

SPECIAL MOVES

Speed-Kick · Off-Wall Attack · Spike-Charge

COMMAND LIST

THROW → P

SPECIAL ↘ → K

IN THE AIR ↘ → K

SCRAP FINISHER ← ← • → • P

SPECIAL ↙ ↓ ↘ → K

SPECIAL → → P

IN THE AIR ↓ ↙ ← K

DESTRUCTION ↑ • ↓ P



PYROS

POWER FLYER

Its legs are a flared thruster skirt painted with gold flames; its hands are heavy gold blocks. Pyros rides on jets of fire: a spinning ring of flame, a thrust that crosses the arena in an instant and swoops from the air.

SPECIAL MOVES

Fire Spin · Super Thrust Attack · Jet Swoop

COMMAND LIST

THROW → P

SPECIAL → → → P

IN THE AIR ↓ • P

SCRAP FINISHER → → • ↓ ↓ • P

SPECIAL ↓ • P

SPECIAL → → P

IN THE AIR → → P



ELECTRA

ZONER

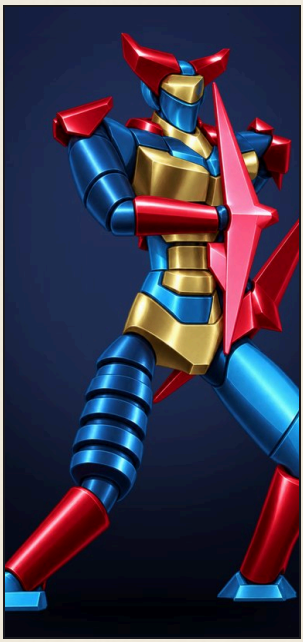
A slender, spiky robot with a crystalline torso and lightning crackling in its hands. Electra keeps its opponents at a distance with ball lightning, thunder rolling along the floor and a spray of electric shards.

SPECIAL MOVES

Ball Lightning · Rolling Thunder · Electric Shards

COMMAND LIST

THROW → P	SPECIAL ↙ ← P
SPECIAL ↘ → P	SPECIAL ↘ → → P
SPECIAL → → P	IN THE AIR → → P
SCRAP FINISHER ↓ • → • P	DESTRUCTION ↑ ↗ → ↘ ↓ P



KATANA

SWORDSMAN

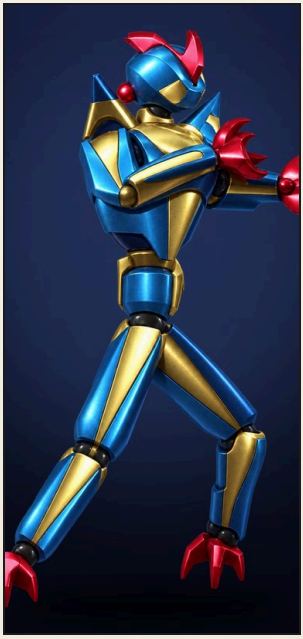
A samurai among robots: a horned red crest, gold chest armor and long red blades along its forearms. Anything that jumps at the Katana meets the rising blade; anything that stays down gets its head stomped.

SPECIAL MOVES

Rising Blade · Head Stomp · Razor Spin

COMMAND LIST

THROW → P	SPECIAL ↓ ↙ ← P
SPECIAL ↙ ↓ ↘ → P	SPECIAL ↘ → P
SPECIAL ↘ → K	SPECIAL ↙ ← K
IN THE AIR ↘ → P	SCRAP FINISHER → ↘ ↓ ↙ ← P
DESTRUCTION ← ↙ ↓ ↘ → P	



SHREDDER

RUSHDOWN

Lean and agile, with a red horned crest and clawed hands that can leave its arms and fly at the opponent. Head-butts and flip kicks make the Shredder one of the most aggressive robots in the arena.

SPECIAL MOVES

Head-Butt · Flip Kick · Flying Hands

COMMAND LIST

THROW → P

SPECIAL ↘ → P

SPECIAL ↓ ↓ K

SCRAP FINISHER ↓ • → • P

SPECIAL ↙ ↓ ↘ → P

SPECIAL ↓ ↙ ← P

IN THE AIR ↘ → P

DESTRUCTION ↓ • ↑ ↑ • P



FLAIL

GRAPPLER

Top-heavy and unorthodox: a wide armored head-body on a coiled spring, rolling on a spiked wheel and swinging chains with spiked balls. The Flail spins opponents into throws and charges in fists first.

SPECIAL MOVES

Spinning Throw · Charging Punch · Swinging Chains

COMMAND LIST

THROW → P

SPECIAL ↙ ← ← P

SPECIAL ↓ • K

IN THE AIR → → K

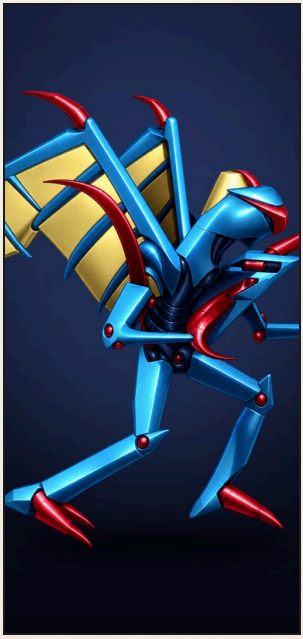
DESTRUCTION ← • → P

SPECIAL → → K

SPECIAL ← ← P

SPECIAL ↓ • P

SCRAP FINISHER → → → P



GARGOYLE

AIR

A winged demon of steel, with bat-like mechanical wings, a horned head and red talons. The Gargoyle owns the air: diving claws, flying talons and a charge on its wings.

SPECIAL MOVES

Diving Claw · Flying Talon · Wing Charge

COMMAND LIST

THROW
→ P

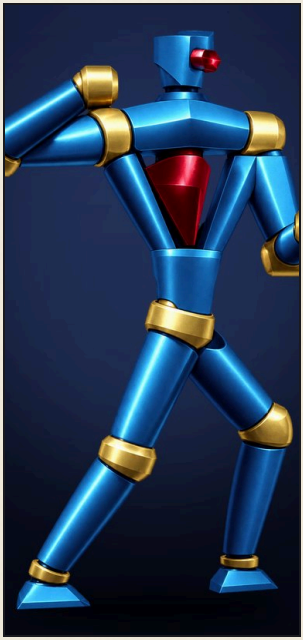
SPECIAL
→ → P

SPECIAL
↘ → P

IN THE AIR
→ → P

SCRAP FINISHER
← ↙ ↓ ↘ → P

DESTRUCTION
↓ • ↑ • ↓ • P



CHRONOS

TECHNICAL

Sleek and tall, with smooth limbs, round gold joints and a red triangle on its chest. Chronos bends the rules of space: it teleports across the arena, phases through solid matter and freezes its enemies in stasis.

SPECIAL MOVES

Small-Scale Teleportation · Matter Phasing · Stasis Activator

COMMAND LIST

THROW
→ P

SPECIAL
↘ ↓ ↙ ← P

SPECIAL
↓ • P

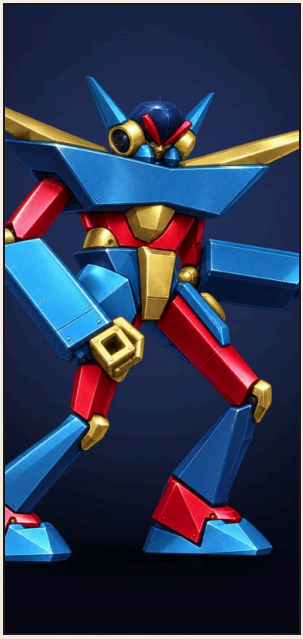
SPECIAL
↙ ← P

SPECIAL
↙ ← K

IN THE AIR
↙ ← K

SCRAP FINISHER
↓ • → P

DESTRUCTION
→ • ← • P



NOVA

THE FINAL MACHINE

Major Kreissack's own super-robot: bulky angular armor, a gold horn crest across its head and shoulders, and fists that launch grenades and missiles. Nova waits at the end of the road. It is not on the select screen, but pilots have been known to find it anyway.

SPECIAL MOVES

Mini grenade · Missile Launcher · Earthquake smash

COMMAND LIST

THROW
→ P

SPECIAL
↓ ↘ → P

IN THE AIR
↓ ↘ → P

DESTRUCTION
↓ ↓ • P

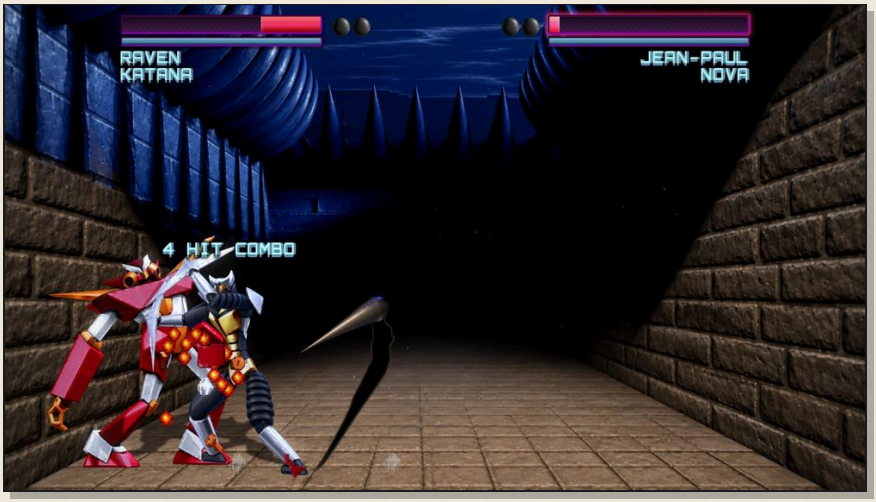
SPECIAL
↓ ↓ P

SPECIAL
↙ ← P

SCRAP FINISHER
↓ ↙ ← • → P

ENHANCEMENTS

In tournament play, a pilot who does well earns **enhancements** for their robot, which unlock more of its moves. The move list shows a move once it is unlocked.

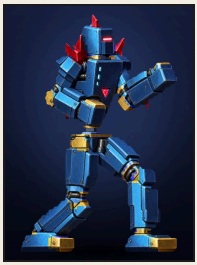


THE DANGER ROOM *Jean-Paul's Nova against Raven's Katana, the wall spikes waiting.*

CHAPTER 7

NEW CHALLENGERS

Built for the Remastered Edition in the spirit of the originals, and rendered in HD from their 3D models. They come as a mod: turn it on in **Extras › Mods**, and they join the robot select screen (a third row), the computer's opponents and Plug's trades.



GLACIER

HEAVYWEIGHT

A heavy ice juggernaut, slow, strong and hard to put down, crowned with red ice crystals. It throws spears of ice, charges shoulder first on a slide of ice and stomps frost spikes out of the floor.

THROW	ICE LANCE	GLACIAL RAM
→ P	↘ → P	↙ ← K
FROST SPIKES	**SCRAP FINISHER**	**DESTRUCTION**
↘ → K	↓ • ↑ • ↓ P	↑ • ↓ • ↑ K

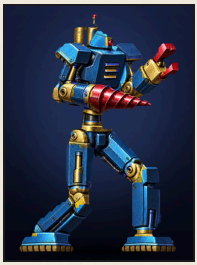


TEMPEST

AERIAL

Light and fast, a wind robot with swept fins streaming back from its head. Its jumps are high and floaty: it throws whirlwinds, rises in a spinning kick that hits again and again, and dives out of the sky before you see it coming.

THROW	GALE BLAST	CYCLONE KICK
→ P	↙ ← P	↘ → K
SKY DIVE (AIR)	**SCRAP FINISHER**	**DESTRUCTION**
↓ K	↑ ↑ • ↓ P	↓ ↓ • ↑ K



HELIX

ARMOR BREAKER

An industrial driller with a spiral drill for one arm and a claw for the other, built to break armor and dig in. It charges drill first, drives up in a corkscrew uppercut and fires its drill head across the arena like a missile.

THROW	DRILL RUSH	CORKSCREW
→ P	↘ → P	→ ↓ ↘ P
DRILL BIT	**SCRAP FINISHER**	**DESTRUCTION**
↙ ← P	← ← • → P	→ → • ← K



SPECTRE

PHANTOM

A phantom in a hood and a cloak of blades, with lasers built into its forearms. It fires bolts of light, fades out to reappear behind its opponent and dashes in on a kick that trails afterimages.

THROW	PHOTON BEAM	PHASE SHIFT
→ P	↘ → P	↙ ← K
SHADOW STRIKE	**SCRAP FINISHER**	**DESTRUCTION**
↘ → K	↓ • ↑ ↑ P	↑ • ↓ ↓ K

CHAPTER 8

THE PILOTS

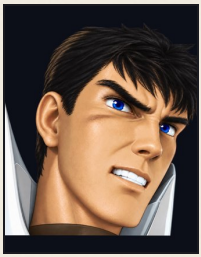
Ten pilots fight on the W.A.R. circuit. Each brings a body and a mind to the neural link: their **power**, **agility** and **endurance** shape every robot they pilot, and the computer plays each of them with their own personality.



CRYSTAL

Forced to fend for herself after her parents mysterious death, Crystal's determination has earned great respect.

POWER
AGILITY
ENDUR.



STEFFAN

Although he is the youngest competitor in tournament history, Steffan fights with skill beyond his years.

POWER
AGILITY
ENDUR.



MILANO

Recruited by Raven for his outstanding kickboxing skills, Milano's speed and dexterity are legendary.

POWER
AGILITY
ENDUR.



CHRISTIAN

Christian's aggressive style strikes fear in the minds of competitors and desire in the hearts of many young women.

POWER
AGILITY
ENDUR.



SHIRRO

Over his many years of competition, Shirro has developed unrivaled power, yet retains a youthful sense of humor.

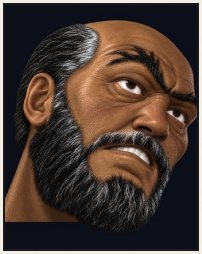
POWER
AGILITY
ENDUR.



JEAN-PAUL

His calculating and devious nature along with well-rounded abilities often intimidate Jean-Paul's opponents.

POWER
AGILITY
ENDUR.



IBRAHIM

A retired triathlete, Ibrahim's patience and honesty have made him a valued mentor to many aspiring competitors.

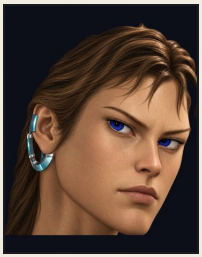
POWER
AGILITY
ENDUR.



ANGEL

Angel's past is shrouded in mystery. Aside from her reclusive disposition and strong will, little is known of her.

POWER
AGILITY
ENDUR.



COSSETTE

A veteran fighter, Cossette has become cautious, defensive, and bitter after being crippled in the arena.

POWER
AGILITY
ENDUR.



RAVEN

As major Kreissack's bodyguard and right-hand man, Raven has beaten and humiliated many inside, and outside, the arena.

POWER
AGILITY
ENDUR.



MAJOR KREISSACK

The master of the W.A.R. tournament circuit, and its final opponent. Kreissack pilots Nova, and he has never been told no.

POWER
AGILITY
ENDUR.

TOURNAMENT PILOTS

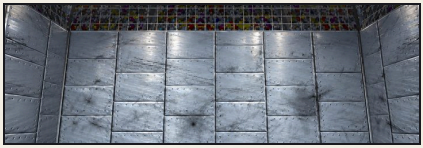
Tournament play has its own pilots too: dozens of challengers across the circuit, each with a face, a robot and a record.



CHOOSE YOUR PILOT *The pilot's stats and story on top, the ten pilots below. Crystal is picked.*

CHAPTER 9

THE ARENAS



STADIUM

Where W.A.R.'s machines get their first public testing: a steel pit under floodlights, the crowd behind the cage net.



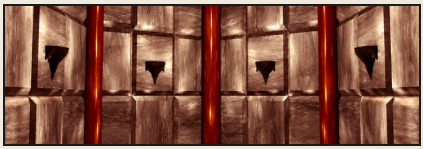
DANGER ROOM

Spikes shoot out of the walls. Keep your opponent against them, and yourself away from them.



POWER PLANT

Built inside a lightning-receptive power plant: the walls deliver electric shocks.



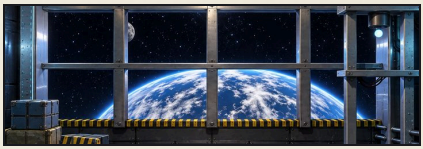
FIRE PIT

Holographic spheres ignite fireballs under the fighters, over a grate of glowing lava.



THE DESERT

Golden dunes at sunset, and fighter jets strafing anything that stands still.



ORBITAL NEW

A space station's hangar deck, the Earth in the window, sparks drifting in low gravity.



ICE CAVE NEW

A frozen cavern under the aurora: blowing snow, frost mist, sparkling crystals.



ROOFTOP NEW

A skyscraper roof in the rain above a neon city; lightning over the skyline.



ABYSS NEW

A glass dome on the sea floor: rising bubbles, caustics, light from far above.

HAZARDS

The arenas' hazards hit both robots alike. The **Gameplay** menu can turn them off.

CHAPTER 10

TOURNAMENT PLAY

The tournament is the heart of One Must Fall 2097: a career on the W.A.R. circuit, from the first qualifying bout to the world title.

YOUR PILOT

Choose **Tournament play** and create a pilot: a name, a face, a robot and your three colors. Your pilot starts with modest skills and a little money. Careers are saved, so you can come back to them.

THE CIRCUIT

Each tournament is a ladder of opponents, each with a robot, a pilot and a ranking. Beat them to climb the ladder and collect **prize money**. The later tournaments pay more and hit harder, and the champion of each waits at the top of its ladder.

THE MECH LAB

Between fights, the **mech lab** is your garage. Spend your winnings on your robot's **arm and leg power**, **armor**, **arm and leg speed** and **stun resistance**, and on training your pilot's power, agility and endurance.

TRADING ROBOTS

Plug, the mech lab's salesman, will trade your robot for another, for a price. Every robot of the circuit can be yours. With the new robots turned on, he sells those too.

THE NEWS

After every fight, the WRDE news tells the world what happened in the arena, and what they think of you. The newsreader reads each report aloud in the voice of the announcer you chose.



THE HOLDING BAY *Before every fight, the two robots face each other in the holding bay, and so do their pilots.*

CUSTOM TOURNAMENTS

Make your own circuits from the installed tournaments (**More modes › My tournaments**): fewer opponents (spread over the ranks, the champion always among them), their robots as they were or on the new robots, more or less prize money. They appear in Tournament play like the others, and can be shared as **.omftrn** files.

PRO TIP

Money is tight early on. Armor and stun resistance keep you in fights you would otherwise lose; power upgrades end fights sooner. Do not buy a new robot until you have won with the one you have.

CHAPTER 11

ARCADE, SURVIVAL AND TIME ATTACK

Under **More modes**, three modes for pilots who want a straight fight and a score to beat:

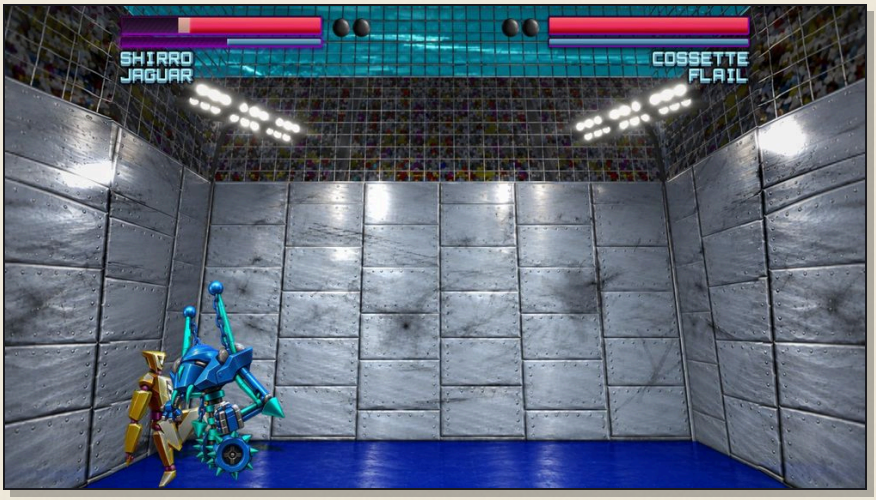
MODE	HOW IT WORKS
Arcade	Eight fights, the computer better and better each time. Major Kreissack is last.
Survival	One round against one opponent after another, with only the health you have left. How far can you go?
Time attack	Five fights against the clock.

RECORDS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

Extras › Records keeps your statistics (fights, wins, knockouts, finishers, your favorite robots) and the best results of each mode. Twenty **achievements** wait to be earned, announced with a banner the moment you get them. They are for bragging rights only: nothing in the game is locked behind them.

VICTORY SCREENS

After one and two player fights, the winner gets a victory screen: the pilot's portrait, the robot, a line for the loser, and the fight in numbers (rounds, time, hits, accuracy, best combo, perfects and finishers).



THE STADIUM *Shirro's Jaguar and Cossette's Flail open the evening.*

CHAPTER 12

THE TRAINING LAB

Training (in **More modes**) puts you against a dummy that never gets knocked out, with health refilling after every combo. The pause menu's **Training lab** holds the tools:

- **Frame data** F8: a frame meter for both robots and the startup, active and recovery frames of your last move, with your advantage after it hit or was blocked.
- **Hitboxes** F9: what can be hit and where attacks hit. Hits in this game are pixel exact.
- **Record the dummy** F5 / F6: take control of the dummy, record up to 25 seconds, and let it play back over and over.
- **Reversals**: the dummy answers on the first possible frame after a hit, a block or a knockdown.
- **Combo trials** for every robot, each with a demo, from its special moves to its hardest combos.
- The **input display** lists your recent inputs and how long each was held.



THE LAB *Frame meter on top, inputs on the left, the last hit and the combo at the bottom.*

CHAPTER 13

REPLAYS AND THE ROBOT WORKSHOP

REPLAYS

Every fight is saved. Extras › Replays keeps the last 40, plus any you mark to keep. Watch at any speed from ¼ to 4×, pause, step frame by frame, jump anywhere on the timeline. Mark a clip and save it as an **MP4 video** with the game's sound, or as an **animated GIF**. Replays are shared as **.rec** files, the original game's own recording format.

THE ROBOT WORKSHOP

Build your own robots from the new robots' parts: the frame of one, the head of another, the special moves and finishers of a third, a size, a weight class and three colors, with a live picture as you go. The game builds a complete fighter on the spot, ready to try in training or against the computer. Share them as **.omfbot** files.



INSTANT REPLAY *Helix against Spectre in the Abyss, with the replay controls.*



THE WORKSHOP *A Spectre frame, a Tempest's moves, orange accents: pick the parts, see the robot.*

CHAPTER 14

THE REMASTERED LOOK



CLASSIC *320 × 200, 256 colors: exactly as in 1994.*



REMASTERED *The same frame, in HD and widescreen.*

F2 switches between the two looks at any time. The **classic** look is the original drawing pipeline, pixel for pixel, with sharp, smooth or CRT scanline scaling. The **remastered** look draws every picture in high definition from 3,200+ redrawn images, and keeps every palette effect of the original working: player colors, fades, flashes and tints.

REMASTERED EFFECTS

Fights get a layer of modern effects driven by what happens in the fight: sparks and flares on hits, light from impacts, fire and projectiles, shockwaves, the knockout camera, and each arena's own atmosphere (embers, blowing sand, floodlights, snow, rain, bubbles). They never change the fight itself. Each group can be switched off in **Options › Graphics › Effects**, with bloom; the fight camera, the HUD style and the typeface are in **Options › Graphics › Remastered**.

In widescreen the arena reaches past the original screen, but the fight stays inside it: faint **energy curtains** mark its edges, glowing where a robot is held against them and rippling when one is slammed into them.

SLOW COMPUTER?

The game lowers its resolution by itself when the graphics card struggles. For the fastest game, press F2: the classic look runs on anything.

CHAPTER 15

TIPS FROM THE PROS

1. LEARN ONE ROBOT

Every robot plays differently. Pick one, learn its special moves in the training lab, and win with it before you try the next.

2. BLOCK LOW

Most pilots attack low more than they think. Crouch blocking stops sweeps and low kicks; jump-ins you can see coming.

3. THROW THE TURTLE

An opponent who blocks everything cannot block a throw. Walk in and grab.

4. WATCH THE ENDURANCE BAR

Yours and theirs. A stunned robot is a free combo: be the one landing it.

5. USE THE ARENA

Wall spikes, electric fences and jets do not care whose side they are on. Put the other robot between you and them.

6. MIND THE PILOT

A quick pilot makes a fast robot faster; a strong one turns a light robot into a hitter. Try the same robot with three different pilots.

7. READ THE FRAME DATA

If a move leaves you at a disadvantage after it is blocked, stop throwing it out. The training lab's frame meter tells you which moves are safe.

8. SPEND WISELY

In tournaments, put your first prize money into the upgrades that keep you winning, not into a shiny new robot.

9. WATCH THE COMPUTER

The computer pilots use every special move of their robots. The demo mode is the oldest strategy guide there is.



THE ICE CAVE *Five consecutive hits: Ibrahim's Glacier against Milano's Tempest.*

CHAPTER 16

TROUBLESHOOTING

PROBLEM	SOLUTION
Windows says it protected my PC.	The download is not signed yet. Choose **More info**, then **Run anyway**.
My Mac won't open the game.	It is not notarized by Apple yet. Open **System Settings › Privacy & Security** and choose **Open Anyway**.
The game runs slowly.	Press F2 for the classic look, or turn off effects in **Options › Graphics › Effects**.
My gamepad does nothing.	Press any button on it once: the game only sees a pad after a button press. Check **Options › Controls**.
There is no sound.	Click or press a key once: browsers only start sound after you do. Check the volumes in **Options › Sound**.
Where are my screenshots?	In **Downloads › OMF 2097 Remastered**, with exported replays and clips (in a browser, in its downloads).
I cannot find Nova.	That is between you and the robot select screen.

YOUR MONITOR'S TOO BRIGHT!

Pilots of the original game who turned their monitors all the way up found a message hidden in the crowd on the main menu. It is still there in the remaster, painted into the front row. Look closely.

TRIVIA

The game's own text file still holds a placeholder for the final boss's biography, left in by the original developers: *"Boss guy's description. This really won't be seen, but we'll make space for it anyway."* They were right: it never appears in the game. It does now, in this manual.

CHAPTER 17

CREDITS

ONE MUST FALL 2097

© 1994 **Diversions Entertainment**. Published by **Epic MegaGames**. Freeware since 1999. The original team's credits roll at the end of the game: finish the tournament to see them.

THE REMASTERED EDITION

Human coder	Jared Woodruff
AI coder	Claude Opus 5.5 (Max Mode)
AI image rendering	OpenAI GPT6-ASTRA (Ultra Mode)
Credits theme	*Twenty Ninety-Seven (Remix)* by Hadal Static
Announcers	Victor and Kristen, from the ElevenLabs voice library

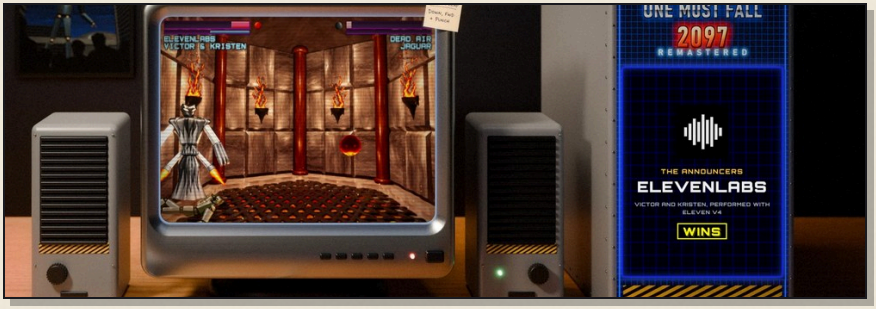
BUILT WITH

The reverse engineering of the **OpenOMF** project; **Orbitron** by Matt McInerney and The League of Moveable Type; Hyllian's **xBR** shader; **ElevenLabs** for the announcers' voices, **FFmpeg**; **Tauri**, **Vite**, **TypeScript** and **Vitest**. The full list is in the game: **Extras › Credits**.

NEVER PAY FOR THIS GAME

One Must Fall 2097 is freeware: its owners let everyone share it, as long as nobody charges for it. The game's files and the artwork made from them come with this remaster on those terms. The remaster's source code is MIT licensed. This is an unofficial fan project, not affiliated with or endorsed by the original authors. All trademarks belong to their owners.

github.com/Jared-woodruff/OMF-2097-Remastered



EXTRAS › CREDITS *The remaster's credits are fought out on an old PC, scored to Hadal Static's Twenty Ninety-Seven (Remix): every credit pilots a robot in its own colors, lands its final blow on the beat and takes its place on the tower.*



NINETY-FOOT ROBOTS. ONE MUST FALL.

The 1994 robot fighting classic, rebuilt for today's computers: the original game, pixel for pixel, and a remastered edition in HD, one key apart.

15 ROBOTS
The original eleven and four new challengers

9 ARENAS
Spikes, electric fences, fireballs and jets

TOURNAMENT CAREER
Prize money, upgrades, the mech lab

TRAINING LAB
Frame data, hitboxes, combo trials

REPLAYS & CLIPS
Every fight saved, MP4 and GIF

ROBOT WORKSHOP
Build your own HARs

FREE
Freeware since 1999

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